Gabriel Dougherty

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Designer and developer with a year of hands-on experience building websites, apps, and graphics for real users. Most of my design work happens in Figma, from full site layouts and individual graphics to product UI, and I use AI tools like Claude and Cursor to move quickly from an idea to something people can actually use. Recent work includes freelance web design for a local campaign and a prompt engineering platform I built on my own. Before that I spent a summer on continuous improvement at a manufacturing plant and worked as a TA for intro Python at Virginia Tech for two years.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Web Designer & Developer *August 2026 - Present*

Rock Hill, SC

- Designed and launched a responsive, multi-page campaign website in Wix for a local school board candidate, including candidate bio, platform priorities, events, voter information, and supporter tools (email signup, volunteer, contact, and donation-support forms), all connected to the campaign's social channels.
- Drove 661 sessions from 506 unique visitors in the site's first period, primarily through mobile and organic Facebook traffic, and generated 21 form submissions, including 11 volunteer sign-ups.
- Developed and embedded a custom, mobile-friendly district lookup tool that takes a visitor's address and returns their school board seat, current trustee, and 2026 election information, with interactive district boundary mapping.

Continuous Improvement Intern, Ebara Pumps America *June 2025 - August 2025*

Rock Hill, SC

- Ran time studies and workflow analysis across assembly, painting, testing, and crating, then wrote up findings and updated the standard operating procedures based on what I saw.
- Worked with assembly and logistics teams to spot bottlenecks and improve processes, including restructuring shipping and warehouse layouts to move product through faster.

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, CS 1014 (Python) *Fall 2024, Fall 2025*

Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA

- Ran weekly lab sessions for students who had never coded before, breaking down Python and computational thinking in whatever way made sense for each person.
- Met with students one on one, gave written feedback on their work, and adjusted how I explained things based on where each student actually was.

Team Leader & Communications Coordinator, Chick-fil-A Mall Road *January 2020 - August 2022*

Union, KY

- Got promoted twice in 18 months. Led shifts, trained team members, wrote the weekly internal newsletter, and built a feedback process that gave frontline staff a direct line to leadership.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Astora - Prompt Engineering Platform & Chrome Extension *2026 - Present*

- Built a full-stack web platform and Chrome extension for writing, testing, and refining prompts for AI systems, which put me deep into prompt evaluation and building repeatable AI workflows.
- Wrote the requirements and prompts that shaped the build, designed the UI/UX in Figma, and set up Stripe for subscription payments.

AI Meal Planning App & Fitness Tracking App (iOS, both published) *2026 - Present*

- Scoped and shipped two subscription iOS apps: a meal planner that uses OpenAI and Anthropic APIs to generate personalized meal plans, and an offline-first fitness tracker. Handled the requirements, QA, testing, RevenueCat setup, and App Store submission for both.

EDUCATION

Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA

Coursework toward B.S. in Aerospace Engineering, 2022 to 2025

Dean's List Spring 2024, President's List Fall 2024 | GPA: 3.03

SKILLS

Figma (UI/UX, Web & Graphic Design) | Web Design & Development (Wix, Responsive Sites, Embedded Tools, Interactive Mapping, Forms, Analytics) | AI-Assisted Development (Claude, ChatGPT, Cursor, Lovable) | Prompt Design & Evaluation | Product Requirements & QA | REST API Integration | HTML/CSS/JavaScript | Python | Stripe / RevenueCat